ADV 115

ACTIVISM

DEFINITION OF ACTIVISM

Activism is an organized and intentional effort to bring about social, political, institutional, or cultural change.

It typically comes into play when the arms of government begin failing.

Core Objective: Taking concrete actions to challenge injustice, correct systemic failures, and promote reforms that advance the common good.

ADVOCACY VERSUS ACTIVISM

FEATURE	ADVOCACY	ACTIVISM
1. Primary Focus	Persuasion and representation.	Mobilizing people to create visible, structural change.
2. Approach	Dialogue, policy influence, speaking on behalf of a cause.	Direct action, mobilization, active reform.

PROFILE OF AN ACTIVIST

An activist is an individual who:

- Refuses to remain passive in the presence of wrongdoing.
- Recognizes that silence in the face of injustice is form of enablement.
- Strongly believes that principled action enables meaningful change.

ACTIVISM IN THE UNIVERSITY SETTING

This serves as a vital mechanism for voicing, elevating, and promoting students' opinions and rights.

CHARACTERISTICS OF EFFECTIVE ACTIVISM

Effective activism is not synonymous with disorder. To be effective and impactful, activism must be:

- **Purpose-Driven:** Guided by a clear, specific, and achievable goal.
- **Evidence-Based:** Backed by facts, data, and verifiable information.
- **Lawful:** Conducted strictly within constitutional boundaries and institutional rules.

LAW 112

DOCTRINE OF SEPARATION OF POWERS.

Separation of power is the constitutional principle whereby the powers are divided among the three separate organs.

One of the fundamental principles of separation of power ensures that the different organs perform their duties, prevent abuse of power, and checkmate each other. They act independently of others. The purpose is to make sure that no organ is more powerful than others. They check mate and balance everything to prevent power tussles.

HOW THEY CHECKMATE EACH OTHER:

- The legislature makes laws, draft budget, and checkmate the executives.
- The executive enforces the law made by the legislature, they formulate the government policy. They maintain law and order.
- The judiciary interprets the law. They resolve disputes, protect fundamental rights, punish offenders and review governmental actions.

OBJECTIVE OF SEPARATION OF POWERS:

- **To prevent tyranny:** To prevent one arm of government to excessively use power against others.
- To promote accountability.
- Protection of liberty.
- Promotion of democracy.

This system is called check and balance.

DISADVANTAGE

- It may cause delay in decision making.

The legislative powers are invested in the house of assembly and national assembly.

ADVANTAGES OF SEPARATION OF POWERS

- They explain the structure of government
- It promotes democratic governance.

PTS 114

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN HOUSE OF ASSEMBLY AND HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. **THE NATIONAL LEVEL (FEDERAL GOVERNMENT)**

At the national level, legislative power in Nigeria is exercised by the National Assembly. The House of Representatives consists of 360 elected members who deliberate in what is commonly referred to as the Green Chamber. Their primary function is to make laws that apply across all 36 states as well as the Federal Capital Territory (FCT). Within the chamber, elected officers such as the Speaker, Deputy Speaker, and Chief Whip are designated as Honourable Members. In contrast, key administrative and enforcement personnel including the Sergeant-at-Arms, Clerk, and Deputy Clerk are non-honourable officers who support the operations of the house.

2. **THE STATE LEVEL**

At the state level, lawmaking is handled by the House of Assembly. The members of this legislative body are also known as Honourables, but their legislative jurisdiction is strictly limited to their respective states. Their core responsibility involves enacting local legislation and overseeing state governance, including the restructuring and regulation of local markets, public schools, and community infrastructure.

3. **THE SUG LEVEL (STUDENT UNION GOVERNMENT)**

The Student Union Government mirrors statutory governmental structures through its legislative and judicial arms.

LEGISLATIVE ARM

The legislative body operates within the Hallowed Chambers, where the MSRC (Member, Student Representative Council) makes laws for the student body. Much like the national

parliament, its leadership includes Honourable Members such as the Speaker, Deputy Speaker, and Chief Whip, while officers like the Sergeant-at-Arms, Clerk, and Deputy Clerk serve in non-honourable administrative roles.

JUDICIAL ARM

The SUG Judiciary is entirely distinct and separate from the statutory Judicial System of Nigeria. The Judicial Council is made up of five key members: the Chief Judge, the Judge of Electoral Affairs, the Judge of Halls, and two Directors-General of Academics (DGAs). The primary authority and responsibility of the judiciary is to interpret laws, identify offences, and maintain justice within the university community.

LDR 101

ASPIRATIONS & TIMING FOR LEADERSHIP ASPIRATIONS

LEADERSHIP

The act of influencing others in a group of persons to achieve a common goal or vision.

LEADERSHIP ASPIRATION

An individual's desire, ambition & willingness to take on leadership responsibilities.

QUESTION

- Why do I want to lead?
- What impact do I hope to make?
- Am I prepared for the responsibilities?
- Do I possess the necessary Skills or am I willing to learn?
- Can I prioritize the interest of people I'm leading over mine?
- Can I handle criticism?
- Can I balance leadership & my academics?
- Am I willing to sacrifice my 4 T's?

HOW TO ANSWER

- Seeking Mentorship
- Build Confidence
- Participating in leadership development trainings

- Learning from experienced leaders